

“Behind every absence is a story.

Not of defiance, as it is so often

labelled, but of distress.”

RABBI MARTIN TAUBMAN

Forty years in education

*If your child can't go to school,
this book is for you.*

Not late. Not refusing. Not “just anxious.” Unable.

This is the manual you open at 7 a.m. in the
kitchen, when there is nothing left to try.

INSIDE

- The Sanctuary Home Protocol
- The Won't vs Can't distinction
- The Inarguable Evidence Binder
- Section 19, EHCP, EOTAS – the routes
that force the system to act

STEPHEN MALLETT

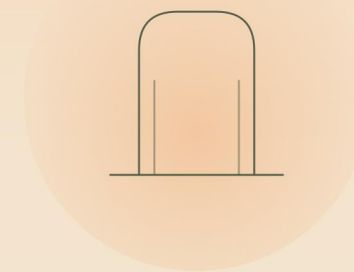
Former Headteacher · SENCo · SEN Parent

Founder of SEND Navigate · sendnavigate.org

NOT REFUSING. UNABLE.
STEPHEN MALLETT

“Where hope begins.”

MATTHEW FERGUSON · TEACHER & PARENT



You are not failing.

Not Refusing. Unable.

*The UK parent's manual for school distress,
EBSA, and the way through.*

STEPHEN MALLETT

Former Headteacher · SENCo · SEN Parent

Founder of SEND Navigate · Author of Parent Shield